The Fourth Sheet

Example report · Not-for-profits

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

What does it cost to raise a dollar?

Period: September 2026. What fundraising costs (grant writing, donor campaigns, events) for every dollar it brings in. Pick a source and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

September 2026 Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

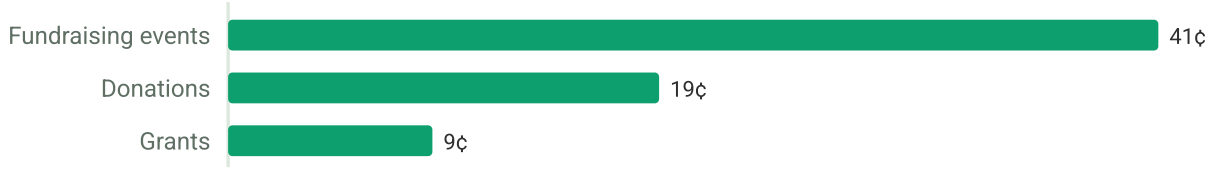
In short: Each dollar raised cost 20¢ in September, and 15¢ a dollar this financial year to date.

Source: All fundraising

September · all fundraising
20¢
August 13¢

Year to date (Jul to Sep 2026)
15¢
same period last year: 16¢

Cost to raise a dollar, by source, September 2026 (cents)



What it shows
September cost 20¢ to raise each dollar, against 13¢ in August. Fundraising events raised $41,600 and cost $16,900. This financial year to date it has cost 15¢ a dollar, against 16¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
The year-to-date figure is steadier than single months: events make some months jump. Pick a source above to see which one moves it.

Source: Grants

September · Grants
9¢
August 10¢

Year to date (Jul to Sep 2026)
10¢
same period last year: 12¢

What it shows
Grants cost 10¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($21,300 of grant writing and reporting for $223,318), against 12¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Usually the cheapest money to raise, as long as the time that goes into applications and acquittals is protected.

Source: Donations

September · Donations
19¢
August 12¢

Year to date (Jul to Sep 2026)
16¢
same period last year: 14¢

What it shows
Donations cost 16¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($9,800 of donor campaigns for $60,600), against 14¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Steady and cheap, and untied: the money that builds reserves.

Source: Fundraising events

September · Fundraising events
41¢
August none raised

Year to date (Jul to Sep 2026)
46¢
same period last year: 41¢

What it shows

Fundraising events cost 46¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($19,300 of event costs for $41,600), against 41¢ in the same period last year.

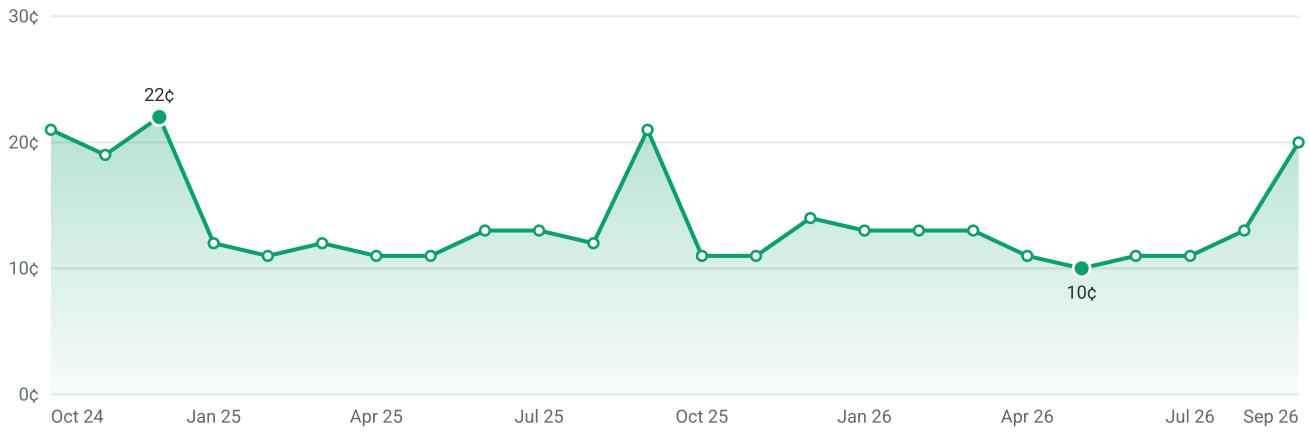
What you'd do about it

Usually the dearest money to raise: events are worth counting for what else they bring too (new donors, profile).

Every source at once

Cost to raise a dollar, by month (cents)

All · Cents per $1



Months with an event (the gala, the Christmas appeal) jump. A gap means nothing was raised that month. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.